Emmanuel Bakopoulos.

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Founder of v2byVELARE, a streetwear brand I started at 16, now running at $1.2M+ a year and up 30% year over year. I set up and ran every part of the company myself, from product design and manufacturing to operations and marketing, and taught myself to code so I could build software that makes it run faster and cheaper. Finished high school in June 2026 and chose to build full time before college.

experience

Founder, v2byVELARE (Velare LLC)

June 2025 – Present

- $1.35M in sales and 15,400+ orders since June 2025, fully bootstrapped. $138K in the first full month, best month $213K and 2,500+ orders (Dec 2025)
- Run the full operation: product design, overseas manufacturing ($240K+ in production in 2026), paid ads, SMS, fulfillment, cash and a 3 person contract team
- Built an 89K follower Instagram and 16K SMS list, mostly organic, that power limited drops. Best day $45K
- Directed $195K+ in Meta ads with an outside agency, holding ~5x revenue per ad dollar in scale months

Head of Growth & Marketing, QuantMap

Oct 2026 – Present

Quant analytics platform that maps key price levels on CME futures, crypto and 10K+ US stocks before the open, graded at the close. Seen in Forbes, Business Insider, Yahoo Finance and Investopedia.

- Brought in by the founders to own growth end to end: paid acquisition, funnel, tracking, content strategy and the sales team (hiring, scripts and pay for setters and closers)
- Wrote the go-to-market roadmap in my first two weeks: audited the site, track record and payment risk, mapped 22 competitors, and redesigned the funnel around a live trader-led demo that closes on the call
- Built the financial models the roadmap runs on: cohort churn, acquisition cost ceilings, operating costs by phase, sales team pay and a path to $1M in monthly revenue
- Built the new landing pages (one per trader skill level, plus checkout) and the full Meta Pixel + Conversions API tracking spec for the dev team; designed the member referral program

Founder, VELARE (first brand)

Aug 2024 – July 2025

- Started at 16 with no audience. First drop sold 2 of 100 units (my mom and a friend). Grew to about $100K in year one
- Survived $30K of inventory stuck in customs, then relaunched as v2byVELARE at 6x the monthly revenue

things i built

Self-taught with Python and AI coding tools (Claude Code) since January 2026. 12 projects, 40K+ lines of code.

- **Content engine:** an AI system that learns what makes short-form video spread, then makes it. Tracks every one of my 800+ reels live through the official Instagram API and, with a partner, 104K+ posts across 403 brands. Writes, voices and edits new videos, with a panel of AI viewers grading every cut before it posts. Where it's going: organic content you can optimize for reach, clicks or sales the way Meta optimizes ads
- **Drop Gate:** virtual queue so drops never crash. Load-tested to 2,583 shoppers at once, 0 failures, $5/month server
- **Cash Deck:** the system I run v2's money on. Syncs 44K+ Shopify Payments transactions, simulates cash week by week, and sizes every production order to the cash we'll have
- **Quant research:** backtester to catch fake edges (blind holdouts, real costs, preset kill rules), ~210K ideas screened
- **AI operating system:** 13 always-on agents and a 590+ note knowledge base that rank new revenue moves nightly

other

- Started Execution Group, a 250+ member community of young brand founders, and wrote a 71-video founder course
- Spoke at NYU Stern (Sep 2025) on using AI in startup marketing
- Paid model and creator for 12+ streetwear brands; organized a group popup during NYFW (Feb 2026)
- Given away $57K+ in clothing (about 800 pieces), 250+ to shelters and youth programs
- Irvington High School, June 2026. Admitted to Northeastern. Varsity soccer 4 yrs, piano 10 yrs, fluent Spanish